



▲ **Reversing inclines** were an ingenious answer to the problem of trains having to move up extremely steep gradients. The idea was later used during the construction of similar railway lines in the Andes Mountains in South America. This image shows the reversing incline at Bhore Ghat in 1880.

British colonial and commercial interests clearly lay in connecting Bombay to other administrative and commercial centres across the country. On Lord Dalhousie's behest, John James Berkley, the chief resident engineer for the Great Indian Peninsula Railway (GIPR), conducted a series of surveys in the Western Ghats region that lay between Bombay and Poona. After years of study, he zeroed in on Bhore Ghat in the south-east and Thul Ghat in the north-east to lay the lines towards Poona and Nashik, respectively.